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(c) Historical Particularism

The concept of historical particularism was given by Franz Boas in his book Race, Language and Culture.

He argued that society should not be studied ~~is~~ through single lens. Each and every society should be rather studied in its own perspective.

As per Boas, various societies evolve in a particular manner through different historical processes. Hence, they should be studied differently.

Boas emphasized on conducting fieldwork and was against any generalizations made. This way, he also rejected the idea of ethnocentrism.

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During the Baffin island expedition, his idea of historical particularism led to the rise of cultural relativism.

Cultural relativism was the study of society in its own perspective and through natives' view.



Bore was criticised by many on historical particularism. They argued it would lead to redundancy of data and too much work overload.

Despite criticism, historical particularism set a new paradigm in anthropology regarding fieldwork tradition.

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significant points

Revise